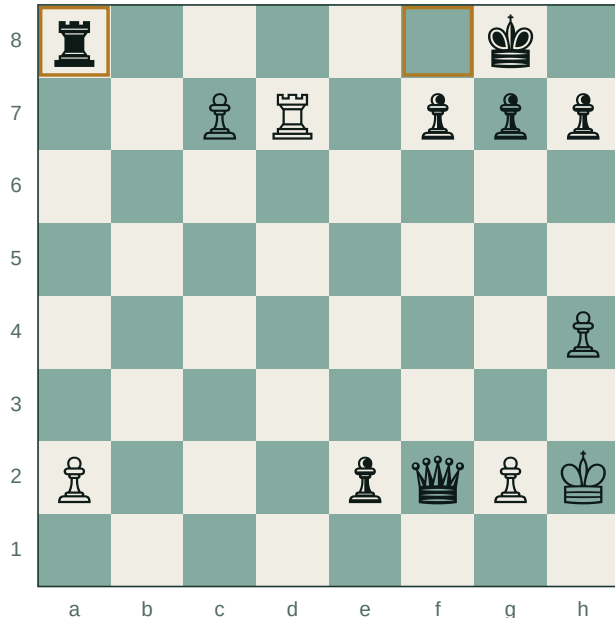


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 34

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 33...Rxa8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34. Rd8+ Rxd8 35. cxd8=Q#

34.Rd8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From d8 it attacks king on g8 and rook on a8. Recorded reply: **34...Rxd8**.

35.cxd8=Q# Mate: queen on d8 gives check; Black has no legal reply. The pawn becomes a queen.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on d8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on f2. Check for tactical protection.